frightening away more moderate supporters to their cause.[157] The policy of the Indian government, which had been to largely ignore the extremists and allow them to talk themselves out seemed to have been successful. The Indian government remained cautious, though, for, as Chelmsford noted, it was still early days and there was no way yet of knowing whether the anti-government agitators were simply lying low for now, making underground preparations.[158]

The greater test for the policy of the Indian government came with the involvement of Afghanistan in the Caliphate issue. On 3 March 1920 Chelmsford had relayed to Montagu the emir's wish to send a deputation from Afghanistan to Britain in order to make his sentiments known there on the Turkish peace. As the viceroy noted, such a move was probably designed to enhance Amanullah's reputation in Asia by making himself appear as the champion of Islam. While Chelmsford wanted to encourage such ambitions in order to bring Afghanistan and Soviet Russia to clash over Asia,[159] Montagu vetoed the idea, fearing that allowing the emir a say over the Turkish peace would only enhance his ability to influence Muslim hostility against Britain.[160] It was with the signing of the Treaty of Sèvres by Turkey in August that the real trouble began, however. It was a 'great disappointment' for Indian Muslims.[161] Amanullah had made known through a proclamation that he would welcome into Afghanistan any Muslims who wanted to escape from their ruler for religious reasons. With this encouragement, some 20,000–30,000 Muslims decided to perform Hijrat (religious migration) during the month of August, as a protest against the treatment of Turkey by the Allies.[162] A Central Hijrat Office with branches all over India was opened, and a propaganda campaign launched.[163] With such a large movement of people, the Indian government was unsurprisingly anxious, particularly Hamilton Grant, who was now chief commissioner of the North-West Frontier Province, from where the majority of the Muhajirun (those performing Hijrat) originated. Nevertheless, despite such worries, Grant also realised that the least interference that his administration made in the movement, the better.[164] In this policy of allowing things to take their course Grant was supported by Chelmsford. For one thing, as was observed, 'the people are extraordinarily orderly' and there was little need for action in order to keep the peace.[165]